



Part-6

OpenLDAP

Roaming Profiles

The previous article in this series focused on configuring Linux client authentication through LDAP. Here, we aim to provide you with a centralised home directory that will contain all the profile details and users' data.

Before we get into creating centralised authentication and roaming profiles, we need to look at the process that ensures all users on the network get access to their data, irrespective of the location or system they log on to. It might be beyond the scope of an article pertaining to LDAP, but it is important in the context of centralised authentication environments, where all users must have access to their desktop. This feature is an essential requirement in modern computing environments and therefore, I feel the need to elaborate on auto-mounting here.

Let's get down to work

The test environment for this month's article is as follows:

- OpenLDAP server consisting of user names, passwords and other required details running on RHEL 5.4 (IP = 192.168.122.1, hostname - vbg.knafl.org)
- Linux client running RHEL 5.5 (virtualised over KVM, IP

=192.168.122.82, hostname - rdso.knafl.org)

As I write this, we are awaiting the launch of RHEL 6. I have had a chance to grab my copy of the latest RHEL6 and am enjoying the SPICE (simple protocol for independent computing environments) experience on my laptop. For those of you who are uninitiated into KVM and SPICE, I would suggest you visit www.spice-space.org. It is an exciting protocol and holds much promise. [Also, a brief article by me on SPICE, appeared in the February 2010 edition of LFY.]

In the previous article, we had discussed how to configure Linux client authentication through LDAP. Here, I will provide users with a centralised home directory, that will contain all the profile details and user data. The only way to achieve this is to keep a central location of file shares, and depending on the users who log on to a client, their particular home folder should get mounted at the desired path.

First, let's achieve the desired functionality, manually.